



TEACHER TRAINING PROGRAM

From Theory to Practice

An Eight-Week Teacher Training Program
Based on the Model–Observe–Reflect (MOR) Strategy

MODEL

OBSERVE

REFLECT

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ABOUT THIS PROGRAM

From Theory to Practice is an eight-week teacher training program designed by Rayene Medabis, M.Ed, for EFL and content-area teaching teams. The program follows the Model–Observe–Reflect (MOR) strategy: a cyclical, evidence-based approach that positions every teacher as both a practitioner and a learner. Rather than delivering theory in isolation, MOR embeds professional learning directly into the act of teaching, making growth visible, collaborative, and immediate.

The program covers four interconnected professional domains: communicative language teaching and task design; classroom observation and data-driven feedback; human-centric classroom management and wellbeing; and responsible integration of AI and digital tools. Each week follows an identical structural format so that the learning cycle itself becomes a transferable habit.

THE MOR STRATEGY

MODEL The trainer demonstrates the skill, concept, or protocol being targeted. Teachers observe as learners, not observers. The model is always authentic — a real lesson, a real debrief, a real prompt — never abstract.	OBSERVE Teachers observe in real or recorded classrooms using shared, calibrated tools. The emphasis is on describing actions rather than interpreting them. Peer observation replaces top-down evaluation.	REFLECT Structured group debriefs, individual journaling, and micro-goal setting close every cycle. Reflection is not optional — it is the mechanism by which observation becomes changed practice.
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PROGRAM AT A GLANCE

Week	Title	Theme	Key Practical Outcome
1	Communicative Competence	Communicative Language Teaching	Information-gap design & task redesign
2	Task-Based Learning (TBL)	TBL Framework	Three-phase TBL design & piloting
3	Interaction Design	Information-Gap Mechanics	Multi-level gap design & interaction tracking
4	Observation Literacy	Data-Driven Observation	Descriptive scripting & live peer observation
5	Post-Observation Debriefs	Feedback & Coaching	E-A-S debrief framework & micro-goal co-construction
6	Human-Centric Classroom Mgmt	Engagement & Pacing	Engagement tracking & breathing moments
7	Emotional Regulation & Boundaries	Teacher Wellbeing	Boundary scripts & emotional journaling
8	Prompt Engineering	AI & Digital Literacy	CRAFT framework & LMS feature

Week	Title	Theme	Key Practical Outcome
	& LMS		integration

How to Use This Program

Each week opens with a Week Banner identifying the theme and week number. The Info Table summarizes duration, format, and target group.

Learning Objectives are numbered and anchor the session. Each objective maps to at least one Model, Observe, or Reflect activity.

MOR Phases are color-coded throughout: BLUE = Model, GREEN = Observe, AMBER = Reflect. These colors are consistent across all eight weeks.

The Weekly Micro-Goal (amber box at the end of each week) is the single most important takeaway: one specific action to implement before the next session.

Appendices A through F provide reusable tools — checklists, trackers, protocols, and activity banks — that support the full eight weeks and beyond.

WEEK

1

THEME: Communicative Language Teaching
Communicative Competence**Rethinking What Language Instruction Is For**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + weekly peer observation cycle
Format	Trainer-led demonstrations, peer observation, group debrief
Target Group	All teaching staff (EFL, content-area, or mixed)

This opening week challenges teachers to rethink the fundamental purpose of language instruction. Rather than beginning with grammar rules, we begin with a question: when do students genuinely need language to accomplish something? The week introduces communicative competence theory, the mechanics of information-gap tasks, and the MOR framework that will structure the entire program.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define the four components of communicative competence: linguistic, sociolinguistic, discourse, and strategic
- Distinguish between form-focused and meaning-focused instruction in EFL contexts
- Design at least one information-gap activity that activates clarification, confirmation, and information-request functions in students
- Experience both the grammar-presentation and communicative task formats from the learner's perspective and articulate the difference

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer delivers two contrasting mini-lessons: (1) a traditional grammar-presentation lesson on modal verbs; and (2) a task-based lesson in which students plan a trip and modal verbs emerge naturally from communicative need. Teachers participate as learners in both.
- Whole-group debrief: 'Which lesson required you to actually use language? When were you producing meaningful output versus repeating structures?' Trainer records responses on the board without editorial comment.
- Trainer maps the observed moments onto Canale and Swain's four components of communicative competence using specific examples from the mini-lessons — grounding the theory in lived experience rather than definition.
- Introduction to information-gap activities: why a communication gap — not a gap-fill — is the engine of genuine interaction. The gap creates a need; the need creates language.

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Teachers watch a 15-minute classroom video and use the Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A) to document student communicative behaviors. Observation is silent and individual.
- Look-fors include: number of student-initiated turns, instances of clarification requests and confirmation checks, evidence of genuine information exchange versus rote recitation or mechanical response.
- Pair calibration: compare checklists and identify three specific points of divergence. These become the discussion focus — not who was right, but what the divergence reveals about how we see classrooms.

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Whole-group reflection: 'In your current practice, where are students actually communicating — and where are they performing communication for the teacher?'
- Individual journaling (10 min): Identify one upcoming lesson where a grammar-presentation slot could be replaced by an information-gap activity. What would the non-linguistic outcome be? What language would students need to use?
- Pairs: Each teacher commits to designing and running one information-gap activity before Week 2. Plans are recorded in the Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B).

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE TASK REDESIGN CHALLENGE

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- In pairs, teachers receive a grammar-drill activity and a Task Design Card with four guiding prompts: What is the non-linguistic outcome? Who holds what information? What does a successful exchange look like? What language function does the task require?
- Task: Redesign the drill into a communicative activity without removing the target language. The grammar must emerge from the task, not precede it.
- Gallery walk: pairs post their redesigns and leave written comments on at least two other designs. Comments must be evidence-based: 'This creates a gap because...'
- Whole-group debrief: What language functions did your redesigned task require? What would a student say that they could not have said in the drill version?

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Canale & Swain (1980) excerpt on communicative competence (provided by trainer)
- Sample information-gap task templates (Appendix F)
- Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A)
- Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B)
- Task Design Cards (provided in session)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Before Week 2, design and deliver one information-gap activity in your classroom. Document what students actually said, whether they requested clarification or confirmed information, and whether the non-linguistic outcome was achieved. Bring your field notes to Session 2.

WEEK

2

THEME: Task-Based Learning Framework

Task-Based Learning (TBL)**Designing for Non-Linguistic Outcomes**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + peer observation cycle
Format	Trainer-modeled full TBL lesson, TBL Design Lab, peer review, gallery walk
Target Group	All teaching staff

Week 2 takes teachers into the Task-Based Learning framework. The central shift is this: the goal of the lesson is a real-world outcome, and language is the tool to get there — not the destination. Teachers learn to adapt complex academic or social topics into manageable, collaborative tasks that generate natural language use without overt grammar instruction at the front of the lesson.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand and apply the three-phase TBL cycle: Pre-Task, Task Cycle (task → planning → report), and Language Focus
- Identify the non-linguistic outcome in any given task design and articulate why it matters pedagogically
- Adapt a complex academic or social topic into a manageable, collaborative TBL task appropriate for their learner group
- Evaluate the communicative quality of task designs using the TBL Task Checklist

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer models a complete TBL lesson: 'The Community Event Planner.' Pre-Task: topic activation, vocabulary access through authentic materials, task briefing. Task Cycle: groups plan and pitch a community event, then one group reports. Language Focus: trainer highlights specific language that emerged naturally and runs a 10-minute form-focused analysis.
- Post-lesson debrief: 'What was the non-linguistic outcome? When did grammar appear — and who introduced it first? What did the teacher do? What did the teacher deliberately not do?'
- Trainer unpacks the three-phase structure and maps each phase to observable teaching behaviors. Key question: 'What does the teacher's role look like in each phase? How does it change?'
- Discussion: The difference between a task and an activity. A task has a non-linguistic outcome; an activity is language practice. Why does this distinction matter for learner motivation and output?

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Teachers observe a peer-taught or video-based TBL lesson using the TBL Observation Checklist. Focus: Is there a clearly defined, non-linguistic task

outcome? Is language incidental to task completion? Are students collaborating rather than performing for the teacher?

- Post-observation documentation: write three evidence-based observations using only descriptive language. Evaluative language (good, clear, effective) is not permitted in the observation notes.
- Pair debrief: Share one observation that surprised you. What did it reveal about what TBL looks like versus what you expected?

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Round-table: 'What was the hardest TBL principle to maintain in the lesson you observed — and what does that tell us about our current teaching habits?'
- Personal reflection: 'Where does my current teaching depend most on grammar as the goal rather than as the means? What would need to change?'
- Micro-goal commitment: Draft a TBL task outline for your class this week, including a clearly stated non-linguistic outcome. Record in the Micro-Goal Tracker.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE TBL DESIGN LAB

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Teams choose one of three topic cards: academic (a school fundraiser proposal), social (a neighborhood safety plan), or vocational (a staff training schedule).
- Design a three-phase TBL lesson plan with a clearly stated non-linguistic outcome, a collaborative student task, and a post-task language focus that emerges from the task — not precedes it.
- Peer review using the TBL Task Checklist: Does this design have a real-world outcome? Is language incidental? Would collaboration genuinely be required?
- Gallery walk: teachers annotate designs with sticky-note comments before a brief whole-group share-out.

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Willis & Willis (2007) TBL overview excerpt (provided by trainer)
- TBL Task Checklist (provided in session)
- Topic Cards for Design Lab (provided in session)
- Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Pilot one TBL task with your class this week. After the lesson, write three sentences: (1) What was the non-linguistic outcome? (2) Did students achieve it? (3) What language emerged naturally that you had not planned for? Bring this reflection to Week 3.

WEEK

3

THEME: Information-Gap Mechanics & Student Interaction Patterns

Interaction Design**Building Gaps That Force Communication**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + peer observation with interaction tracking
Format	Multi-level demonstrations, interaction analysis, Gap Design Studio
Target Group	All teaching staff

Week 3 zooms in on the mechanics of information-gap design. Teachers explore what makes a gap genuinely communicative across proficiency levels and learn to track and analyze student interaction patterns as classroom data. The week builds directly on Weeks 1 and 2 by training teachers to design interaction scaffolds that force students to clarify, confirm, and request — rather than guess, stay silent, or wait for the teacher.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand the structural and pedagogical requirements of effective information-gap activities at different proficiency levels
- Design tasks that require students to perform clarification, confirmation, and information-request language functions
- Differentiate and scaffold information-gap tasks across proficiency levels from A1 through B2
- Use an Interaction Tracking Form to document and analyze student communication patterns objectively

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer models three versions of the same information-gap activity adapted for A1–A2, B1, and B2 proficiency levels. Teachers experience each version as learners, noting how the language demands and scaffolding differ.
- Debrief: 'What language functions were activated at each level? What scaffolding made each version accessible? What would structurally collapse if you removed the information gap?'
- Analysis: 'The gap is not a knowledge gap — it is a communication gap. What is the difference? Why does this distinction change how we design tasks?'
- The Comfort Trap: trainer names the common tendency to reduce the gap when students struggle — and explains why this removes the communicative necessity that the task depends on.

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Teachers observe a peer-led information-gap activity using the Interaction Tracking Form, recording: who spoke, which language functions were used (clarify, confirm, request, describe), and the ratio of student-initiated to teacher-prompted turns.
- Compare tracking forms in pairs: 'Where did students take initiative? Where did they wait for permission? What does that ratio tell us?'
- Focus question: 'Were students communicating, or were they performing communication? What is the observable difference?'

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Data analysis: 'Look at your Interaction Tracking Form. What patterns surprised you? What would you predict for a different class or proficiency level?'
- Group discussion: 'The Comfort Trap revisited — have any of you caught yourself reducing a gap in the moment? What triggered it? What would you do differently?'
- Micro-goal commitment: Identify one interaction protocol to introduce in your next lesson and predict how it will change student output.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE GAP DESIGN STUDIO

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Each teacher selects a target language function from the function card set (clarify, confirm, request, describe, or compare) and designs a multi-level information-gap set with three versions: low, mid, and high.
- Peer swap: exchange tasks and try each other's designs as a learner. Give feedback on two dimensions: communicative necessity (does the gap force the function?) and scaffolding appropriateness (does the support match the level?).
- Whole-group debrief: Which design choices produced the richest student output in your experience? What would you change before using this with a real class?

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Interaction Tracking Form (provided in session)
- Language Function Cards (provided in session)
- Sample information-gap activities across proficiency levels (Appendix F)
- Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

In your next lesson, introduce one interaction protocol that structures how students must communicate — for example, 'before you answer, you must ask one clarifying question.' Document whether it changes the quantity and quality of student output. Note at least three specific student utterances you would not have heard without the protocol.

WEEK

4

THEME: Data-Driven, Non-Evaluative Classroom Observation

Observation Literacy**Documenting Actions, Not Interpretations**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + first live peer observation cycle
Format	Video calibration, scripting practice, live peer observation
Target Group	All teaching staff (observer and observed roles rotate)

Observation becomes genuinely useful only when it captures what actually happened — not what the observer assumed was happening. Week 4 trains teachers to shift from evaluative language to precise, behavioral documentation. It introduces the shared Peer Observation Look-For Checklist, launches the first live peer observation cycle, and begins building a team culture in which being observed is a learning opportunity rather than a source of anxiety.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Distinguish between descriptive and interpretive observation notes using concrete, side-by-side examples
- Use the shared Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A) accurately and without evaluative language
- Conduct classroom scripting to capture teacher-talk time, student-talk time, transition durations, and question types
- Build confidence in peer observation as a collegial, collaborative practice that belongs to everyone — not a tool of management

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer narrates a classroom video in real time, modeling two contrasting registers: interpretive ('The teacher explained the task clearly') and descriptive ('The teacher gave verbal task instructions for 4 uninterrupted minutes. One student was asked to repeat the instructions. No comprehension check followed.').
- Teachers practice converting five interpretive statements into descriptive ones using the Observation Language Exercise. Pairs compare their rewrites and discuss where differences appear.
- Introduction to the shared Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A): structure, purpose, and one critical operating principle — 'Our job as observers is to give the teacher data they could not collect themselves. Not a verdict.'
- Calibration exercise: Watch a 6-minute video clip independently, complete the checklist, then compare in pairs. Identify three items where your checklists diverge and discuss what caused the difference.

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- First structured live peer observation cycle using the shared checklist. Each teacher takes the observer role for a minimum of 30 minutes.
- Observer documents only observable, time-stamped behaviors: transition durations, teacher-talk versus student-talk ratio, question types (display, referential, procedural), and instruction-delivery sequence.
- No evaluative language. If the observer catches themselves writing an interpretation, they pause and rewrite it as a description of what was seen and heard.

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Post-observation pair share: 'What did you notice that you would have missed without the checklist? What was hardest to observe without slipping into judgment?'
- Whole-group: 'Why does the language we use to observe matter — for the observer, for the teacher being observed, and for the feedback conversation that follows?'
- Micro-goal commitment: Before Week 5, use at least one specific, time-stamped observational data point in a feedback conversation with a peer. Record how the conversation differed from previous feedback exchanges.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE CALIBRATION EXERCISE

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Watch the same 6-minute classroom video clip as a group. Complete the Look-For Checklist independently — no discussion until everyone is done.
- Compare results across the full team: Where did the group agree? Where did significant divergence appear? What does the divergence reveal about our individual observation filters?
- Rewrite three anonymized observation notes from previous feedback sessions (provided) — converting all interpretive statements to descriptive ones without losing the substance of what was observed.
- Whole-group debrief: 'After this exercise, what will you do differently in your next observation?'

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Peer Observation Look-For Checklist (Appendix A)
- Observation Language Exercise sheet (provided in session)
- Anonymized observation notes for rewriting exercise (provided in session)
- Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Before Week 5, use one specific piece of observational data — time-stamped, behavioral, and non-interpretive — in a feedback conversation with a colleague. Record how the conversation compared to feedback exchanges that were based on impressions. Prepare to share this in Session 5.

WEEK

5

THEME: Feedback, Coaching, and Professional Growth

Post-Observation Debriefs & the Micro-Goal Framework**From Data to One Actionable Next Step**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + second live peer observation cycle with full debrief
Format	Trainer-modeled debrief, triad role-play, live debrief practice
Target Group	All teaching staff

The post-observation debrief is where observation data either becomes fuel for professional growth or disappears into a feedback form. Week 5 introduces the E-A-S Framework — Evidence, Analysis, Suggested Micro-Goal — and trains teachers to conduct debriefs that result in one clear, actionable next step. The key insight: one implemented micro-goal is more powerful than ten unimplemented suggestions, however precise.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Structure a post-observation debrief using the E-A-S Framework: Evidence → Analysis → Suggested Micro-Goal
- Use observational data — not impressions, assumptions, or general feedback — as the exclusive basis for debrief conversations
- Co-construct one actionable micro-goal with the observed teacher, implementable in their very next lesson
- Experience both the observer and observed roles in a complete, structured debrief process

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer models a complete post-observation debrief using footage from the Week 4 observation cycle. The demonstration follows E-A-S: opening with a teacher self-assessment question, presenting one specific evidence point from the checklist, facilitating collaborative analysis, and co-constructing one micro-goal. The trainer never prescribes; always invites.
- Key principle made explicit: 'The micro-goal belongs to the teacher, not the observer. My job is to surface the data and ask the right questions. The change belongs to them.'
- Teachers identify what the trainer did and explicitly avoided doing during the debrief. Discussion: What made this feel like a conversation rather than an evaluation?
- Introduction to the Debrief Quality Checklist: How will observers evaluate the quality of their own debrief practice going forward?

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Second structured live peer observation cycle. Before observing, each observer selects one specific evidence point to focus on, identifies one open-ended analysis question to ask, and prepares a micro-goal prompt.
- Following the observation, each pair conducts a full E-A-S debrief. A third colleague serves as meta-observer, using the Debrief Quality Checklist to evaluate the debrief conversation itself.
- Meta-observer focus: Did the observer stay on evidence? Did they ask before telling? Was one clear micro-goal co-constructed by the end?

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Whole-group debrief: 'How did it feel to receive one clear micro-goal versus a list of suggestions? What was different — in the conversation, and in your motivation to act on it?'
- Discussion: 'Why is one specific, implementable micro-goal more powerful than comprehensive feedback?' Explore the research connection between specificity, agency, and behavior change.
- Personal reflection: 'When have I received feedback that actually changed my practice? What made it different from feedback that didn't? What conditions made it possible?'

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE DEBRIEF TRIADS

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Groups of three rotate through three roles: the observer (conducts the E-A-S debrief), the observed teacher (engages authentically and co-constructs the micro-goal), and the meta-observer (evaluates the debrief quality using the Debrief Quality Checklist).
- Use role-play scenario cards to simulate common debrief challenges: a teacher who deflects feedback ('That was just an off day'); a teacher who is excessively self-critical ('I'm terrible at this'); a teacher who wants solutions rather than questions.
- Whole-group sharing: What worked naturally? What felt scripted? What would you do differently in a real debrief with a real colleague?

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- E-A-S Debrief Framework reference card (Appendix C)
- Debrief Quality Checklist (provided in session)
- Role-play scenario cards (provided in session)
- Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Before Week 6, conduct one full E-A-S debrief with a peer using data from a real classroom observation. Record: What specific evidence point did you use? What micro-goal did the teacher choose? What was the outcome in their next lesson? Bring this to Session 6.

WEEK
6

THEME: Cognitive Engagement, Pacing, and Classroom Dynamics
Human-Centric Classroom Management

Reading the Room — Engagement Over Compliance

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + classroom observation with Engagement Tracking Form
Format	Video analysis, engagement tracking, lesson annotation, real-time practice
Target Group	All teaching staff

A quiet, compliant classroom is not the same as an engaged one. Week 6 trains teachers to distinguish between surface compliance and genuine cognitive engagement using observable behavioral indicators. Teachers learn to read non-verbal cues in real time, adjust pacing dynamically during a lesson, and build deliberate 'breathing moments' into their lesson designs — planned pauses that allow the class to reset and refocus rather than push through until the energy drops without warning.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Identify the behavioral indicators that distinguish cognitive engagement from surface compliance in real classroom contexts
- Read and interpret non-verbal cues accurately: body posture, eye contact, task persistence, facial expression, and peer interaction
- Apply a Real-Time Adjustment Protocol for changing pacing, task format, or direction based on live engagement signals
- Build deliberate breathing moments and re-entry points into lesson plans to sustain engagement across a full session

MODEL PHASE 90 min
• Trainer shows two classroom video clips without narration. One depicts a compliant but cognitively disengaged class; one depicts a genuinely engaged class. Teachers observe and document non-verbal cues independently using the Engagement Tracking Form. • Group analysis: 'What was the teacher doing differently in each clip? What could have been done at the 7-minute mark in Clip 1 to shift the energy? What observable signal should have triggered a change?' • Trainer introduces the Compliance versus Engagement Indicator Chart and the Real-Time Adjustment Protocol: a three-step observation-interpretation-response sequence for teachers to use during lessons. • The breathing moment concept: why building short, unstructured micro-pauses into instruction sustains rather than interrupts cognitive engagement over a full lesson period.

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Live or video observation using the Engagement Tracking Form, recording engagement and compliance indicators at five-minute intervals throughout the lesson.
- Observers also document teacher adjustment moments: specific instances when the teacher noticed an engagement signal and changed pace, format, or direction in response.
- Focus question: 'When did the class lose energy? What observable signal preceded it? What did the teacher do — and what were the available alternatives?'

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Small groups: Share one moment where a class surprised you — when energy was higher or lower than you predicted. What did that moment teach you about your assumptions?
- Whole-group: 'What does it mean for a lesson to breathe? What does a breathing moment look and sound like in your specific teaching context?'
- Personal reflection: 'In my recent lessons, have I been reading for engagement or for task completion? What is the difference in practice — and what is at stake in that difference?'

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE LESSON ANNOTATION EXERCISE

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Teachers bring one upcoming lesson plan (their own or a provided template). Annotate it with three layers: (1) engagement checkpoint moments — specific points to pause and read the room; (2) breathing moments — planned micro-pauses for open response, quiet reflection, or peer share; and (3) re-entry points — clear, concrete options if the class drifts.
- Peer review: Walk a partner through your annotated plan. Ask them: 'Where do you see the energy rising in this design? Where might it drop? What would you add?'
- Whole-group debrief: What surprised you about your own lesson design when you examined it through the lens of engagement rather than content coverage?

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Compliance vs. Engagement Indicator Chart (provided in session)
- Real-Time Adjustment Protocol (provided in session)
- Engagement Tracking Form (provided in session)
- Lesson Annotation Template (provided in session)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Build at least one deliberate breathing moment into each of your lessons this week. After each lesson, note: Did you use it? What observable signal triggered the need for it? How did the class energy change afterward? Bring your notes to Week 7.

WEEK

7

THEME: Emotional Labor, Wellbeing, and Professional Integrity

Emotional Regulation & Professional Boundaries**The Sustainable Teacher**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours)
Format	Case studies, role-play, structured dialogue, reflective journaling
Target Group	All teaching staff

Teaching is emotional work. Week 7 names that reality directly and gives teachers practical, concrete tools for managing it. This session explores emotional labor as a professional reality — not a personal weakness — and provides structured practice in recognizing over-involvement, setting professional boundaries, and regulating emotional responses before, during, and after challenging interactions. The goal is not emotional detachment. It is emotional sustainability.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Recognize the nature and cumulative impact of emotional labor as a core and often unacknowledged feature of professional teaching
- Distinguish between healthy empathy and over-involvement in relationships with students and parents
- Practice boundary-setting language and strategies that are simultaneously warm, clear, and professionally grounded
- Develop at least two personal emotional regulation strategies for use before, during, and after professionally challenging interactions

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Trainer presents two professional case studies: (1) a parent who messages multiple times daily, questions instructional decisions publicly, and expects immediate responses outside working hours; (2) a student who seeks a friendship dynamic with the teacher and discloses information intended to create a confidant relationship.
- Teachers discuss in small groups before a whole-group debrief: 'What is the teacher's professional role in each case? What is it clearly not? What does a warm, professional boundary sound like in each situation?'
- Trainer models scripted boundary-setting responses for each case study: tone is warm and relational; expectations are clear and non-negotiable; the professional relationship is preserved, not severed.
- Introduction to the empathy-over-involvement continuum and the 'pause-and-name' regulation technique: a two-step in-the-moment practice for emotionally charged professional interactions.

OBSERVE PHASE | 90 min

- Self-observation: Teachers begin a three-day Emotional Journal in session using the provided template. Prompts include: What triggered a strong emotional response this week? How did you respond in the moment? What would you do differently? What physical cues tell you that you are approaching your limit?
- In-session reflective prompts: 'Where am I currently giving more than is professionally sustainable?' and 'What do I need permission to say no to?'
- Optional small-group sharing: teachers choose one insight from their journaling to share with a trusted colleague. Sharing is always voluntary.

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Structured group circle: 'What do I need to give less of in my professional role — and what do I need to protect more deliberately?'
- Discussion on professional longevity: 'What keeps excellent teachers in the classroom long-term? What patterns eventually push them out? What does the data say — and what does your experience confirm?'
- Core insight: 'The sustainable teacher is not the self-sacrificing teacher. Naming that difference in practice — not in principle — is the work of this session.'

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: BOUNDARIES IN PRACTICE

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Role-play in pairs using three scenario cards: Scenario A — a parent who sends messages at 11 PM and expects a same-night response; Scenario B — a student who says 'you're the only adult who actually listens to me' and begins sharing content outside the teacher's professional scope; Scenario C — a colleague who consistently leaves unfinished tasks for others without acknowledgment.
- Debrief after each scenario: 'What made the response feel professional? What felt unnecessarily rigid? What left the door too open? What one word or phrase made the biggest difference?'
- Whole-group synthesis: Build a shared set of boundary-setting language stems that the team can use and adapt immediately in their professional contexts.

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- Emotional Journal Template (provided in session)
- Boundary-Setting Script Cards (provided in session)
- Professional Case Study Handouts (provided in session)
- Recommended reading: excerpt on boundaries in professional caregiving roles (provided)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Identify one professional boundary that you need to clarify, re-establish, or communicate for the first time this week. Write it down: what is the boundary, who does it involve, and what would clearly communicating it change — for you, and for the other person? Bring this to your capstone reflection in Week 8.

WEEK

8

THEME: AI Literacy, Ethical Use, and Learning Management Systems

Prompt Engineering & LMS Integration**Teaching Confidently in a Digital-First World**

Duration	Full-day workshop (6 hours) + one week of independent digital practice
Format	Live demonstrations, hands-on design, ethical discussion, program capstone reflection
Target Group	All teaching staff

The final week bridges teaching craft with digital fluency. Teachers learn to write AI prompts that produce natural, pedagogically useful outputs — not robotic, overly academic text — and navigate popular Learning Management Systems with clarity about why and how each feature supports student learning. Critically, this week establishes the ethical and professional framework for AI use in educational settings, ensuring teachers engage with technology responsibly and with student privacy as the non-negotiable center.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Write prompts using the CRAFT Framework (Context, Role, Action, Format, Tone) that produce natural, human-like AI responses suitable for classroom use
- Apply professional data privacy guidelines when using AI tools in educational settings — knowing what can and cannot be shared
- Navigate at least two LMS platforms and articulate the specific pedagogical purpose of their key features
- Integrate one AI prompt and one LMS feature into a lesson plan with a clearly stated pedagogical rationale for each

MODEL PHASE | 90 min

- Prompt Engineering: Trainer models the CRAFT Framework side by side — a weak, generic prompt versus a well-structured CRAFT prompt targeting the same classroom task. The AI outputs are compared live. Discussion: 'What makes AI output feel robotic? What specific prompt choices produce natural, human-like dialogue?'
- LMS Integration: Trainer demonstrates Google Classroom and Canvas (or Moodle). Key features shown include: assigning tasks with embedded learning intentions, tracking student participation as formative data, building low-stakes digital quizzes, leaving audio and written feedback on student work, and organizing materials by unit theme.
- Discussion: 'How does an LMS change the teacher's role before a lesson? During? After? Does it reduce professional workload or create new workload? When is the answer different?'
- Ethical AI Use in Education: trainer presents the Professional AI Use Guidelines (Appendix D), including what data can and cannot be shared, how to evaluate AI output before using it with students, and how to cite AI assistance in professional documents.

OBSERVE PHASE | 60 min

- Teachers test their CRAFT-structured prompts independently and evaluate the AI output using the AI Output Evaluation Checklist: Is it accurate? Is it age-appropriate? Is it natural? Does it serve a genuine pedagogical purpose or is it a novelty?
- Teachers explore one LMS feature of their choosing and draft a student-facing description of how they will use it and why. Pedagogical rationale is required — 'because it is easy to use' is not sufficient.
- Peer share: Describe your chosen LMS feature to a partner and explain the pedagogical reason. Partner asks: 'What problem does this solve for your students? What would be lost without it?'

REFLECT PHASE | 60 min

- Program Capstone Reflection: 'What has genuinely changed in my thinking about teaching since Week 1? Which week challenged me most? Which was most immediately applicable to my classroom?'
- Share one micro-goal from the eight weeks that you implemented. What happened? What surprised you? What did you learn about your own practice?
- Whole-group closing commitment: 'How will I continue applying MOR principles — and the specific tools of this program — after today? What structures will keep this alive?'

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY: THE DIGITAL LESSON BUILDER

Duration: 60 min | Format: Hands-on collaborative activity

- Teachers design a short lesson plan (or adapt one they already use) that integrates one CRAFT-structured AI prompt and one LMS feature. Both must be justified with a specific pedagogical rationale.
- Peer review using two critical questions: (1) Does the AI output serve a real pedagogical purpose, or would the lesson be stronger without it? (2) Does the LMS feature reduce friction in learning, or does it add complexity that benefits the teacher more than the student?
- Final whole-group sharing: 'What surprised you about integrating AI into your lesson planning? What will you never use AI for in this professional context — and why?'

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

- CRAFT Framework Reference Card (provided in session)
- AI Output Evaluation Checklist (provided in session)
- LMS Quick-Start Guides: Google Classroom and Canvas (provided in session)
- Professional AI Use Guidelines (Appendix D)
- LMS Comparison Table (Appendix E)

WEEKLY MICRO-GOAL

Commit to integrating one digital tool (*AI-assisted or LMS-based*) into your regular practice this term. Define the pedagogical rationale clearly. Schedule a check-in with a trusted colleague at the four-week mark to evaluate: Is this tool genuinely serving your students? Is it serving your professional workflow? Adjust based on the evidence — not the novelty.

A**Peer Observation Look-For Checklist**

Observer: _____ Teacher Observed: _____
 _____ Date: _____ Lesson Duration: _____

How to Use This Checklist

Record only what you observe — behaviors, time durations, counts. Do not record interpretations or evaluations.

The 'Evidence / Notes' column is for verbatim quotes, time-stamps, or frequency counts. Never for judgments.

Complete the checklist independently before any debrief conversation. Do not discuss during observation.

Observable Indicator	Evidence / Notes	Observed
SECTION 1: CLASSROOM ENVIRONMENT & SETUP		
Seating arrangement supports the stated task type (pair, group, whole-class)		☐
Learning materials are accessible and clearly organized for students		☐
Task instructions are visible and remain visible throughout the activity		☐
Classroom displays are relevant to current learning and student-produced		☐
SECTION 2: TEACHER TALK & INSTRUCTION DELIVERY		
Instructions are given once, clearly, and followed by a comprehension check		☐
Teacher-talk time (TTT) is proportionate — students speak more than the teacher		☐
Questions include referential questions (genuine answers unknown) not only display questions		☐
Wait time of at least 5 seconds is given after asking a question		☐
Teacher avoids filling silence immediately when students are thinking		☐
Transitions between activities are smooth and use minimal teacher talk		☐
SECTION 3: STUDENT INTERACTION & COMMUNICATION		
Students initiate turns without being nominated by the teacher		☐
Students address each other directly, not only through the teacher		☐
Clarification requests are observed: students ask for repetition or explanation		☐
Confirmation checks are observed: students verify understanding with peers		☐

Observable Indicator	Evidence / Notes	Observed
Information-request functions are used: students ask for data they do not have		☐
Students use the target language for the communicative purpose of the task		☐
Student-talk time (STT) is the dominant mode for at least 60% of the lesson		☐
SECTION 4: TASK DESIGN & EXECUTION		
The task has a clearly defined, non-linguistic outcome		☐
Collaboration is structurally required — not optional or cosmetic		☐
The task creates a genuine information or opinion gap between participants		☐
Language emerges from the task need rather than being pre-taught and applied		☐
The Language Focus phase (if TBL) follows the task — it does not precede it		☐
SECTION 5: COGNITIVE ENGAGEMENT INDICATORS		
Students show sustained on-task behavior without repeated teacher prompting		☐
Non-verbal engagement indicators are present: eye contact, forward posture, nodding		☐
Students ask questions beyond the immediate task requirement (curiosity signals)		☐
Students persist through difficulty rather than immediately seeking teacher help		☐
Positive affect is visible: genuine reactions, energy, or interest in the task		☐
The teacher adjusts pacing or format in response to observed engagement signals		☐

Post-Observation Note: Select ONE evidence point from this checklist to bring to the E-A-S debrief. One specific, time-stamped data point is more useful than a full summary.

B**Eight-Week Micro-Goal Tracker**

Teacher: _____ Trainer / Supervisor: _____
 _____ Program Dates: _____

How to Use This Tracker

Each week, record the single evidence point that informed your micro-goal. Be specific: use time-stamps, frequencies, or verbatim quotes from the observation.

The micro-goal must be implementable in the very next lesson. If it takes more than one lesson, it is a project — not a micro-goal.

The 'Outcome' column is completed after the next lesson. What happened? What changed? What did you notice?

Week	Observation Evidence Used	Micro-Goal Set	Implementation Date	Outcome in Next Lesson	Next Step
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					

Program Reflection: After Week 8, review your tracker from Week 1 onward. Which micro-goal produced the most visible change? What pattern do you notice across the eight weeks?

C**Post-Observation Debrief Protocol: The E-A-S Framework****What the E-A-S Framework Is — and Is Not**

E-A-S is not a feedback formula. It is a conversation structure designed to transfer ownership of professional growth to the teacher.

The observer's role is to surface data and ask questions — not to diagnose, advise, or solve.

A debrief that produces one clear micro-goal the teacher is motivated to implement is more valuable than a debrief that covers ten observations comprehensively.

Debrief Step	Protocol & Guiding Language
Step 1: Open with a Self-Assessment Question	Before presenting any observation data, invite the teacher to reflect first. Example: 'How do you feel the lesson went? Is there a moment you would do differently?' This surfaces the teacher's own awareness and prevents the debrief from feeling like a verdict. Listen without interrupting. Do not agree or disagree yet.
Step 2: Present One Evidence Point (E)	Share one specific, time-stamped, behavioral data point from the observation. Descriptive only. Example: 'I noticed that between the 12- and 18-minute mark, seven of the twelve students were waiting without a task while one pair presented. The waiting students were looking at their phones or writing in notebooks unrelated to the lesson.' Never evaluate. Never say 'I thought' or 'I felt.' Say 'I noticed' or 'I observed.'
Step 3: Ask the Analysis Question (A)	Invite the teacher to make sense of the data. Example: 'What do you think was happening for those seven students during that window?' Or: 'How do you interpret that moment now, with some distance from it?' Your job here is to listen, not to explain. Ask a follow-up question if needed, but do not offer your interpretation unless the teacher is genuinely stuck.
Step 4: Co-Construct the Micro-Goal (S)	Guide the teacher toward articulating one specific, implementable change for their very next lesson. Example: 'Based on what we have just looked at, what is one thing you would want to try differently in your next lesson — something small enough to do this week?' The micro-goal must come from the teacher, not the observer. If they are genuinely unsure, you may offer a choice between two options — never a directive.
Step 5: Record and Confirm	Both parties record the micro-goal in the Micro-Goal Tracker (Appendix B). Confirm aloud: 'So, before our next observation, you are going to [micro-goal]. Is that right?' Schedule a brief informal check-in after the next lesson to hear how it went. This check-in is not a new observation — it is a 5-minute conversation.

Debrief Quality Check (for self-assessment): Did I open with a teacher self-assessment question? Did I present only one evidence point? Did I stay descriptive — no evaluative language? Did I ask before telling? Did the micro-goal come from the teacher, not from me?

D**Professional AI Use Guidelines for Educators**

These guidelines establish the professional standards for AI tool use at Follow Me Academy and apply to all teaching staff. They are designed to protect student privacy, maintain professional integrity, and ensure that AI is used as a pedagogical tool — not a replacement for professional judgment.

WHAT YOU MAY AND MAY NOT SHARE WITH AI TOOLS

You MAY share:	You may NOT share:
Lesson topics, unit themes, and learning objectives	Student names, surnames, or any personally identifying information
Activity types, task formats, and instructional sequences	Student grade data, assessment scores, or performance records
Anonymized sample student language (no names, no identifying details)	Photographs of students, classrooms, or school premises
Teacher-written texts for editing, simplification, or paraphrasing	Student ID numbers, contact information, or family details
General curriculum questions and syllabus planning support	Medical, behavioral, or learning support records
Professional writing: lesson plans, reports, emails (reviewed before sending)	Confidential parent communications or family information
Prompt generation for formative assessment tasks	Any data governed by your institution's data protection policy

EVALUATING AI OUTPUT BEFORE CLASSROOM USE

Never share AI-generated content with students without reviewing it first. Apply the following four-question check:

- **Accuracy:** Is the information factually correct? Could it mislead students or create misconceptions?
- **Age-appropriateness:** Is the language register, topic, and complexity appropriate for your specific learner group?
- **Naturalness:** Does the language read as genuinely human and contextually plausible — or as awkward, overly formal, or stilted?
- **Pedagogical relevance:** Does this output serve the learning objective? Would the lesson be stronger or weaker without it?

PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS & CITATION

- AI is a professional tool, not a co-author. Your professional judgment — not the AI's output — is what you are accountable for.
- When AI has contributed to a professional document (lesson plan, report, training material), note this. Example: 'Initial draft produced with AI assistance; reviewed, edited, and finalized by [name].'
- Do not use AI to write performance assessments, disciplinary documentation, or formal communications on behalf of students or parents.

- If you are uncertain whether a specific use is appropriate, consult the program coordinator before proceeding.

A Note on Professional Integrity

Using AI does not reduce your professional responsibility — it increases your need to exercise critical judgment. The teacher who uncritically shares AI-generated content with students is not being efficient; they are abdicating professional accountability. Use AI to think faster, not to think less.

E Learning Management System (LMS) Comparison Table

The table below compares six LMS platforms by use case, key pedagogical features, cost model, and suitability for EFL and young learner contexts. Selections should be based on your institution's existing infrastructure, your students' age and digital confidence, and the specific pedagogical functions you need.

Platform	Best For	Key Pedagogical Features	Cost Model	EFL / Young Learner Fit
Google Classroom	Schools using Google Workspace	Assignment management, Drive integration, rubrics, audio/written feedback, gradebook, Google Meet	Free for schools	High — simple enough for all levels; strong for assignment-based EFL work
Canvas (Instructure)	Secondary and tertiary institutions	Modules, rich rubrics, SpeedGrader, portfolio tools, discussion boards, analytics dashboard	Institution-licensed	High — strong rubric and feedback tools suit formative EFL assessment
Moodle	Institutions with IT support	Fully customizable, quiz engine, SCORM/xAPI, forums, glossaries, completion tracking	Free (self-hosted)	Medium-High — powerful but requires technical setup and ongoing maintenance
Edmodo	Social-learning focused environments	Discussion boards, badges, polls, assignment management, parent portal	Free (Freemium)	High for teens — familiar social format reduces digital anxiety in younger learners
Seesaw	Primary and early years EFL	Digital portfolio, audio and video recording, parent-sharing, multimodal submissions	Freemium	Very High — ideal for ages 5–12; audio recording is excellent for speaking tasks
Schoology	K-12 and higher education	Course management, assessment builder, analytics, parent and student access, LTI integration	Institution-licensed	High — intuitive interface with strong formative assessment and communication tools

HOW AND WHY TO USE AN LMS: THE PEDAGOGICAL CASE

An LMS is not a filing cabinet. Used with intention, it transforms three phases of the teaching cycle:

- **Before the lesson:** Use the LMS to share preparatory materials, activate prior knowledge, and build vocabulary exposure before students enter the room. This frees classroom time for interaction.
- **During the lesson:** Track participation in real time, push formative quizzes, and manage group tasks. Students can submit work digitally and receive immediate automated or peer feedback on low-stakes tasks.
- **After the lesson:** Leave voice or written feedback on submitted work, track completion data to identify students who need follow-up, and build a cumulative digital portfolio that shows growth over time.

One Rule for LMS Integration

Before adding any LMS feature to your practice, ask: Does this reduce friction for the learner, or does it add steps without a proportionate learning benefit? If the answer is the latter, do not use it. Technology should serve the lesson — not the other way around.

F

Sample Information-Gap Activity Bank

The activities below are ready-to-adapt templates, not prescriptive scripts. Each is designed to create a genuine information gap that forces students to use specific language functions. Adapt the topics, content, and scaffolding to your teaching context and learner profile.

Activity 1: Spot the Difference (A1–A2 | Young Learners & Beginners)

Purpose: Activate description functions (colour, position, size, number). Create a genuine information gap through two near-identical images with five differences.

Setup: Prepare two versions of a scene image (e.g., a classroom, a market, a park). Each version has five differences. Student A sees Version A; Student B sees Version B. They may not show each other their images.

Procedure:

- Student A describes one element of their image. Student B listens and checks: is their image the same or different?
- If different, both students mark the difference on their tracking sheet.
- Students take turns describing until all five differences are found.
- Post-task: pairs share their findings with the class. Teacher conducts a 5-minute language focus on the descriptive language used.

Language Functions: Describing, comparing, confirming, clarifying

Non-Linguistic Outcome: A completed tracking sheet showing five documented differences

Trainer Note: Do not pre-teach vocabulary. Let students draw on existing resources first. Provide a visual vocabulary strip as a scaffold for A1 learners only.

Activity 2: The Incomplete Schedule (A2–B1 | Teens & Adults)

Purpose: Activate information-request and confirmation functions. Each student holds a version of a weekly schedule with different time slots missing.

Setup: Create two versions of a weekly schedule (school timetable, work rota, or event calendar). Each version has different blank slots. Partner A and Partner B have different gaps — together they hold the complete schedule.

Procedure:

- Students may not show their schedules to each other at any point.
- Students take turns asking: 'What happens on [day] at [time]?' The partner responds using their schedule.
- Students request clarification when needed: 'Can you repeat that? Did you say...?'
- When both schedules are complete, partners compare to confirm the schedule matches.
- Post-task: one pair presents the completed schedule to the class. Teacher conducts a 10-minute language focus on question formation and clarification requests used during the task.

Language Functions: Requesting information, clarifying, confirming, reporting

Non-Linguistic Outcome: Two complete and matching schedules

Trainer Note: Resist providing vocabulary before the task. If a student is completely stuck, ask 'What do you want to say?' and help them construct the utterance — do not provide it.

Activity 3: The Decision Brief (B1–B2 | Young Adults & Adults)

Purpose: Activate comparison, evaluation, and negotiation functions. Each group member holds one piece of information needed to make a shared decision. No individual holds enough information to decide alone.

Setup: Choose a realistic decision scenario (selecting a venue for a team event, choosing between two course options, planning a field trip). Divide the relevant information across four cards — each card holds different details: Card A: venue/option details; Card B: cost and budget information; Card C: logistics and constraints; Card D: stakeholder preferences.

Procedure:

- Each group member reads only their own card. No sharing of physical cards.
- The group must discuss, compare, and negotiate to reach a group decision within 20 minutes.
- Each group member must contribute at least three substantive turns (tracked by a peer using a tally sheet).
- The group records their decision and three reasons in writing.
- Post-task: groups present their decisions to the class and field questions. Teacher conducts a 15-minute language focus on the evaluative and hedging language that emerged.

Language Functions: Comparing, evaluating, persuading, hedging, agreeing and disagreeing

Non-Linguistic Outcome: A written group decision with documented rationale

Trainer Note: The teacher's role during the task is observer only. Do not intervene to correct language, redirect the discussion, or provide vocabulary unless a group is entirely unable to proceed. Record language for the post-task language focus.

Extending the Activity Bank

These three activities represent low, intermediate, and higher-order information-gap designs. Use them as templates: change the topic, level, or language function target to create your own. The structural principle — a genuine gap that requires communication to close — remains constant across all adaptations.